9 January 2017

Chris Seale
California Department of Transportation
Gold Run Rest Area
10057 Gold Flat Road
Nevada City, CA 95959

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NOTICE OF APPLICABILITY

GENERAL WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS FOR SMALL DOMESTIC WASTEWATER TREATMENT SYSTEMS ORDER WQ 2014-0153-DWQ

FOR

CALIFORNIA DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION GOLD RUN REST AREA PLACER COUNTY

The California Department of Transportation (Caltrans) submitted a Report of Waste Discharge (RWD) dated 21 April 2016 describing the Gold Run Rest Area wastewater treatment facility (WWTF) in Placer County. Additional information was submitted in May, June, September, and October 2016. Based on the provided information, the wastewater treatment system and discharge is consistent with the requirements of the State Water Resources Control Board (State Water Board) *General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems*, Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ (General Order). This Notice of Applicability (NOA) provides notice that the General Order is applicable to the site as described below. You are hereby assigned Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ-R5215 for the discharge. A copy of the General Order is enclosed and also available at:
http://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf

You should familiarize yourself with the entire General Order and its attachments, which describe mandatory discharge and monitoring requirements. The General Order contains operational and reporting requirements by wastewater system type. Sampling, monitoring, and reporting requirements applicable to your treatment and disposal methods must be completed in accordance with the appropriate treatment system sections of the General Order and the attached Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) 2014-0153-DWQ-R5215. The Discharger is responsible for all the applicable requirements that exist in the General Order and this NOA.

REGULATORY BACKGROUND

Wastewater discharge from the Gold Run Rest Stop WWTF is currently regulated by Waste Discharge Requirements (WDR) Order 95-092, which was adopted on 28 April 1995. WDR Order 95-092 will be rescinded at an upcoming Central Valley Regional Water Board meeting. Effective upon rescission of Order 95-092, the discharge shall be regulated pursuant to the General Order.

EXISTING FACILITY AND DISCHARGE DESCRIPTION

The Gold Run Rest Area WWTF is owned and operated by Caltrans (hereafter "Discharger") and is located on Interstate 80 near the town of Gold Run in Placer County as shown on Attachment A, which is attached hereto and is made part of this NOA by reference. Gold Run Rest Area is located in an area without a regional wastewater collection system; therefore, wastewater is collected and treated on-site. The site plan is shown on Attachment B, which is attached hereto and is made part of this NOA by reference.

The WWTF services eastbound and westbound traffic that stop at the rest area. Wastewater is generated from domestic use such as toilets and handwashing. Wastewater flows by gravity to two 21,300 gallon septic tanks, one installed for each the eastbound and westbound rest areas. Currently, wastewater from the septic tanks is pumped either to a stabilization pond or to a leachfield, which are both located on the westbound rest area property. Wastewater is discharged to the leachfield during the winter months. Effluent from the stabilization pond is chlorine disinfected and discharged to a sprayfield for the remainder of the year. The Discharger proposes to backfill the stabilization pond and decommission the leachfield and sprayfield.

FACILITY CHANGES

By the end of Fall 2018, the Discharger plans to complete construction of a new wastewater treatment system that consists of two lift stations with two grinder pumps each, a primary treatment pond, and two disposal ponds. During construction, the stabilization pond may be used to up until the new pond system is ready to accept wastewater or the rest stop facilities may be closed so that no wastewater is generated.

A lift station with grinder pumps will be constructed for each the eastbound and westbound side of the rest area. The septic tanks will remain in place and be used for emergency overflow protection in case of pump failure. Wastewater will gravity flow to the lift stations and the generated slurry will be pumped to Pond 1 for treatment. Pond 1 serves as an aeration treatment pond and will be lined with a 60-mil high density polyethylene (HDPE) liner. Treated wastewater will be conveyed by gravity flow to either Pond 2 or 3 for disposal, which will occur via evaporation and percolation. The side berms of Pond 2 and 3 will be lined with a 60-mil HDPE liner to prevent seepage and maintain berm stability.

To characterize the depth to shallow groundwater and flow direction, the Discharger installed five groundwater monitoring wells (MW-1, MW-2, MW-5, MW-6, and MW-7) in March and November 2015 near the proposed area of the new ponds. Based on available monitoring data, the downgradient direction of groundwater is to the northeast with a gradient of 0.036 feet per foot. Depth to groundwater ranged from 3 feet to 20 feet below ground surface and groundwater elevations vary seasonally. On 23 April 2015, the Discharger sampled MW-1 and MW-2 to determine groundwater quality. The results indicate chloride ranges from 13 mg/L to 160 mg/L, total dissolved solids range from 190 mg/L to 490 mg/L, and nitrate as nitrogen ranges from less than 0.5 mg/L to 13 mg/L.

As a result of the shallow groundwater depth, all three ponds will be constructed with the base of the pond at 3,100 feet mean sea level (i.e., at grade) to maintain approximately 3 feet of separation to shallow groundwater. The ponds will be constructed with an approximate surface area of 0.7 to 0.8 acres and a depth of 8 feet. With 2 feet of freeboard, each pond will have a wastewater capacity between 4.2 to 4.8 acre-feet.

SITE-SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS AND EFFLUENT LIMITS

Note that the General Order contains prohibitions and specifications that apply to all wastewater treatment systems as well as those that only apply to specific treatment and/or disposal systems.

The specific requirements and effluent limits for the existing treatment system and planned treatment system are summarized below. Once the planned treatment system is operational and the existing system has been decommissioned, you may request that this NOA be revised.

The wastewater treatment operator must be certified and familiar with the requirements contained in the General Order, this NOA, and the MRP.

Requirements by Wastewater System Type, Section B of General Order

B.1 All Wastewater Systems

This applies in its entirety to the Gold Run Rest Area WWTF with the following site specific requirements.

B.1.a Influent flow limits.

Treatment Unit	Flow Limit as Monthly Average
Stabilization Pond[1]	10,000 gpd
Pond 1[2]	10,000 gpd

[1] In operation until the completion of the new wastewater treatment system.
[2] In operation once the new wastewater treatment system is completed.

B.1.l Wastewater system setbacks.

Equipment or Activity	Domestic Well	Flowing Stream	Ephemeral Stream Drainage	Property Line	Lake or Reservoir
Collection System, Septic Tanks, and Dosing Tanks [1]	150 ft.	50 ft.	50 ft.	5 ft.	200 ft.
Ponds [2]	150 ft.	120 ft.[3]	20 ft.[3]	50 ft.	200 ft.

[1] Setbacks from “Septic Tank, Aerobic Treatment Unit, Treatment System, or Collection System” in Table 3 of General Order. Setbacks apply to the collection system, septic tanks, and lift stations.

[2] Setbacks from “Impoundment (undisinfected secondary recycled water) under Wastewater Storage and/or Treatment Ponds in Table 3 of General Order. Setbacks apply to the Stabilization Pond and Ponds 1, 2, and 3.

[3] Setbacks reduced based on information provided in a 24 October 2016 technical report submitted by the Discharger to accommodate the construction of the new treatment pond system. Because Pond 1 will be fully lined and the berms of Ponds 2 and 3 will be lined, the reduced setbacks are expected to be protective of water quality.

B.2 Septic Systems

The current and planned WWTF will utilize septic tanks; therefore this section applies in its entirety until the septic tanks are repurposed as emergency overflow holding tanks.

B.5 Pond Systems

The current and planned WWTF will utilize a pond treatment system; therefore this section applies in its entirety.

B.6 Subsurface Disposal Systems

The existing WWTF utilizes a leachfield disposal system; therefore this section applies in its entirety until the leachfield is decomissioned.

B.7 Land Application and/or Recycled Water Systems

The existing WWTF utilizes a sprayfield land application system; therefore this section applies in its entirety until the sprayfield is decomissioned.

Effluent Limitations, Section D of General Order

This section applies in its entirety to the Gold Run Rest Area WWTF and shall include the following site specific limitations.

Stabilization Pond and Pond 1 Effluent Limitations

The following limits apply to effluent from the Stabilization Pond until it is decommissioned and to Pond 1 once the new WWTF system is operational.

Constituent	Units	Limit
BOD	mg/L	90

Effluent Limit Rationale

The pond treatment system is subject to technology performance effluent limits for biochemical oxygen demand (BOD) as specified in the General Order.

Staff evaluated the need for a total nitrogen effluent limit using the method contained in the General Order and determined that a nitrogen effluent limit is not necessary because the monthly average flow will be less than 20,000 gpd, treatment Pond 1 will be lined, and all ponds are being constructed to maintain a minimum of 3 feet separation from groundwater.

Technical Report Preparation Requirements, Provisions Section E.1 of General Order

The following technical reports shall be submitted as described below:

1. **By 3 April 2017**, the Discharger shall submit a *Spill Prevention and Emergency Response Plan* (Response Plan) consistent with the requirements of General Order Provision E.1.a.
2. **By 3 April 2017**, the Discharger shall submit a *Sampling and Analysis Plan* consistent with the requirements of General Order Provision E.1.b.
3. **At least 60 days prior** to closing the stabilization pond, the Discharger shall submit a *Pond Closure Workplan* that includes, at a minimum, the following information: (a) estimated volume of biosolids in each of the ponds, (b) methods that will be used to remove the biosolids from the ponds, (c) proposed verification sampling locations and analysis methods following removal of biosolids from the ponds, (d) proposed background sampling locations, and analysis methods, (e) method of biosolids disposal and the location where biosoilds are to be disposed, and (f) plans for backfilling the ponds and final grading of the pond areas.
4. **At least 45 days after** closing the stabilization pond, the Discharger shall submit a *Pond Closure Report* that provides results of the pond closure activities and describes any deviations to the *Pond Closure Workplan*.
5. **At least 60 days prior** to lining Pond 1, the Discharger shall submit a *Pond Liner Construction Quality Assurance Plan* that describes the specific construction quality assurance procedures and test methods that will be used to ensure and verify that (a) the liner preparation, installation, and seaming will comply with the specifications; (b) the entire liner is tested following installation to verify that all seams and liner penetrations are leak-free at the time of acceptance; and (c) the entire liner is inspected for visible material defects and construction damage such as holes or tears prior to acceptance.
6. **At least 45 days after** completing construction of the planned wastewater treatment system, the Discharger shall submit a *WWTF Construction Completion Report* that documents that the lift stations and disposal Ponds 2 and 3 were constructed in accordance with the RWD design plans and that the lined wastewater treatment Pond 1 was constructed and lined in accordance with the approved *Pond Liner Construction Quality Assurance (CQA) Plan* and certifies that the pond is fully functional and ready to receive wastewater in compliance with the requirements of the General Order and this

NOA. The report shall include final dimensions and liner specifications and a *Liner Construction Quality Assurance (CQA) Report* that documents all construction observation, testing, and test results for the pond lining system and shows that the lining system was leak-free at the time of completion.

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM

The Discharger shall comply with MRP 2014-0153-DWQ-R5215, which is attached hereto and made part of this NOA by reference.

ENFORCEMENT

Please review this NOA carefully to ensure that it completely and accurately reflects the discharge. Discharge of wastes other than those described in this NOA is prohibited. Prior to allowing changes to the wastewater strength or generation rate, or to the method of waste disposal, you must contact the Central Valley Regional Water Board to determine if submittal of an RWD is required.

Caltrans will generate the waste subject to the terms and conditions of WQ 2014-0153-DWQ-R5215 and will maintain exclusive control over the discharge. As such, Caltrans is primarily responsible for compliance with this NOA, MRP, and General Order, with all attachments. Failure to comply with the requirements in the General Order or this NOA could result in an enforcement action as authorized by provisions of the California Water Code.

ANNUAL FEES

Staff has determined the discharge is a threat to water quality and complexity rating of 3-C. The annual fee corresponding to a threat to water quality and complexity of 3-C is currently $2,088. The fee is due and payable on an annual basis until coverage under the General Order is formally rescinded. Please note that the annual fees are reviewed each year and may change. If the wastewater discharge ceases, you must provide written notice so that we can terminate coverage under the General Order and no longer bill you.

DOCUMENT SUBMITTAL

All monitoring reports and other correspondence should be converted to searchable Portable Document Format (PDF) and submitted electronically. Documents that are less than 50 MB should be emailed to:
centralvalleysacramento@waterboards.ca.gov.

To ensure that your submittal is routed to the appropriate staff person, the following information should be included in the body of the email or any documentation submitted to the mailing address for this office:

Facility Name: Caltrans Gold Run Rest Area, Placer County		
Program: Non-15 Compliance	Order: 2014-0153-DWQ-R5215	CIWQS Place ID: 227451

Documents that are 50 MB or larger should be transferred to a CD, DVD, or flash drive and mailed to:

Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board
ECM Mailroom
11020 Sun Center Drive, Suite 200
Rancho Cordova, CA 95670

Now that the Notice of Applicability has been issued, the Board's Compliance and Enforcement section will take over management of your case. Guy Childs is your new point of contact for any questions about the General Order. If you find it necessary to make a change to your permitted operations, Guy will direct you to the appropriate Permitting staff. You may contact Guy at (916) 464-4648 or at gchilds@waterboards.ca.gov.

Andrew Altevogt For
Pamela C. Creedon
Executive Officer

enc: Water Quality Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ
Monitoring and Reporting Program 2014-0153-DWQ-R5215
Attachment A, Site Location Map
Attachment B, Site Plan
Attachment C, Wastewater Treatment System Schematic

cc w/out enc: Timothy O'Brien, State Water Resources Control Board, Sacramento
Laura Rath, Placer County Environmental Health Department, Auburn